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Quiet Attunement

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QUIET ATTUNEMENT – A DEFENCE OF ANONYMOUS ARCHITECTURE IN A WORLD OUT OF JOINT

In a world of spectacle and object fetishism, Kay Fisker's housing stands as a quiet but powerful alternative. Through a phenomenological reading of nine buildings in Copenhagen, this article argues that Fisker's subtle material vocabulary – vibrant materiality, subtle movement, and compact whole – offers not just an architectural corrective, but a model for sustainable building culture in a biophysically constrained world.

Research article by Nicolai Bo Andersen
25 min

In his monumental manifesto *S, M, L, XL*, Rem Koolhaas famously summarised the break with traditional architectural issues such as coherence, composition, scale, and proportion with the expression "fuck context." (1) Describing architecture as a "hazardous mixture of omnipotence and impotence" that by definition is a "chaotic adventure," Koolhaas set out to destroy and rebuild architectural discourse in what he held as a "painfully utopian enterprise." (2) In a Danish context, the paradigm shift in architecture at the beginning of the twenty-first century was described as a new wave. (3) Using the diagram as a pragmatic design tool, prominent architects regarded buildings as autonomous commodities and visually spectacular objects, being nonchalant about place, tectonics, and materiality. Even today, this pragmatism may easily "allow them to operate in different territories under contradictory political regimes and social conditions." (4)

This understanding of the means and objectives of architectural design is in strong contrast to the work of Kay Fisker (1893–1965), who called for an anonymous and timeless architecture, not fashionable individual objects. (5) In a historic perspective, Fisker is considered one of the key contributors to the development of housing typologies and large-scale projects that provided quality housing for a growing urban population at the time. More relevant than ever, the problem of quality housing seems to be central to architectural practices today. However, as seven out of nine planetary boundaries are transgressed leaving Earth well outside of the safe operating space, (6) it has been argued that demand for energy, materials, and land area needs to be avoided to return to the safe operating space above the social foundation and below the ecological ceiling of the planetary boundaries. (7)

Using nine selected works by Fisker as cases, this article is concerned with the question of architectural quality in a biophysically limited world. Rather than formal analysis of historical, typological, or stylistic aspects, the focus is on the experiential qualities as seen from a first-person perspective. As argued by Steen Eiler Rasmussen: "Understanding architecture [...] is not the same as being able to determine the style of a building by certain external features. It is not enough to *see* architecture; you must experience it." (8) Revisiting nine selected works of Fisker, I argue that they provide a critical corrective to contemporary architectural discourse. Maybe the works of Fisker can point towards an understanding of architectural quality that may inspire future sustainable building culture. Furthermore, the article asks, from a phenomenological-hermeneutic perspective, what characterises nine selected buildings designed by Fisker, and how this relates to the accelerating ecological crisis. The aim is to develop a deeper and more nuanced understanding of the work of Fisker and to (re)consider architectural quality that may recognise sufficiency measures rather than celebrate commodification.

MATERIALS AND METHODS

Nine selected buildings designed by Fisker and photographed by the author are used as empirical material. All buildings are multistorey housing built between 1922 and 1958. Located in central Copenhagen and in the closely surrounding neighbourhoods of Amager, Vesterbro,

Nørrebro, and Østerbro they are all part of the dense city that is constructed in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. The buildings were photographed on 3 October 2023 using an iPhone 14 Pro; ill. 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 7 and 8 recorded with a 48mm focal length (35mm equivalent), f1,78 at ISO64 and ill. 5 and 9 recorded with 24mm, f1,78 at ISO80. Concerned with the building as *gestalt* as one important aspect of architectural quality, the investigation is limited to the building exterior and what can be immediately experienced from street-level. Following Hans-Georg Gadamer's assertion that "the picture has its own being," the images are considered *presentations* that are not mere copies but rather works in their own right. (9) In addition to the recorded images, experienced effects were noted on site.

Afterwards, the images were slightly colour-and-tone adjusted to match each other, and perspective distortions were corrected. Asserting that architectural meaning derives from relationality rather than abstract concepts or an immutable essence, each image has been described and analysed as seen through a phenomenological–hermeneutic lens at the architectural scales of the city, the building and the detail that, in reference to genre painting, may be called landscape, still life, and portrait. (10) The three scales correspond to the relations of building to city, the relations regarding the building gestalt itself, and the relations that concerns detailing and material qualities – all assumed to address different nuances that in total may help describe the experienced qualities of each work of architecture. The images have then been categorised according to the found architectural motives named mesh, figure and conglomeratein a nine-figure grid [ill. 1]. Significant architectural means are described by the concepts of *vibrant materiality*, *subtle movement*, and *compact whole*. (11) The results are being discussed in relation to both Fisker's written discourse and the work of contemporary scholars as well as in relation to the doughnut-shaped framework of social and planetary boundaries of today. (12) I propose that rather than understanding architecture as a typological question or a stylistic exercise, Fisker's work may point towards an alternative definition, characterised by the concept of *quiet attunement*, which may be more relevant today than ever.

ANALYTIC LENS

The phenomenological approach is a systematic and targeted empirical study of lived experience as seen from an embodied, first-person perspective aiming at disclosing architectural phenomena in a nuanced and rich manner. (13) In contrast to a positivist methodology aiming at an (imagined) third-person objectivity, the phenomenological approach is well aware of the researcher's first-person perspective. As pointed out by Shaun Gallagher and Dan Zahavi, in phenomenology "we are no longer primarily interested in what things are – in their weight, size, chemical composition, etc. – but rather in how they appear, and thus as correlates of our experience." (14) In the perspective of New Phenomenology developed by Herman Schmitz, the felt body is a resonating antenna spreading and absorbing emotions as atmospheres. (15) Embodied communication takes place through *synaesthetic qualities* such as the sharp, cutting, delicate, pointed, bright, hard, soft, warm, cold, heavy, massive, gentle, dense, smooth, and rough and *suggestions of motion* such as the radiant, immersive, progressive, rotating, unfolding, or contracting.

Building on this theoretical foundation, the conceptual framework of New Phenomenology in Architecture, concerned with the experienced density, temperature, direction, consistency, lightness, tonality, and orientation, is used methodologically to describe the experienced effects of the nine selected buildings. (16) Importantly, as writing constitutes a linguistic interpretation of the material building language, "even the most precise description, enumerating all visible characteristics, will not give an inkling of what we feel is the essence of the thing itself." (17) As such, the account of the experienced effects aims at approximating architectural qualities to disclose significant phenomena that may often be unarticulated in a manner that may be recognised as meaningful. To develop a better understanding of the nine selected works of Fisker, similarities and differences between the buildings are described, analysed, and finally discussed.

NINE WORKS OF ARCHITECTURE

In the following, the nine selected works are briefly described in the order of their geographic location, going clockwise from Amager in the south, through Vesterbro, Nørrebro, and Østerbro in the north, into the centre of Copenhagen. This corresponds to the order in which the buildings were photographed and described.

Amagerbo (Kay Fisker and S. C. Larsen, 1926) is a solid, rectangular, and semi-open five-storey housing block with a pitched roof [ill. 2]. The clear volume seems like a block, accentuated by broad corner pillars. The façades appear wide and calm. The window openings form a uniform grid, rhythmically interrupted by doors and gutters. Slightly recessed in the façade, the windows create a delicate relief. Brick walls are cool yellow, and the joints are light. The weathered brick façade with traces of repair has a slightly flickering quality. Window casements, frames, and bars are white.

Gullfosshus (Kay Fisker, 1928) is a solid, skewed rectangular six-storey housing block with a pitched roof [ill. 3]. The clear volume seems like a block, accentuated by windows close to the corners. The façades appear progressive and lively. The window openings form a rhythmically repeated shifted grid, interrupted by rounded gates. Rather deep in the façade and lined with red bricks, the windows create a vigorous relief. Brick walls are dark yellow, and the joints are light. The weathered brick façade with traces of repair has a slightly flickering quality. New window casements, frames, and bars are white.

Vodroffsvej (Kay Fisker and C. F. Møller, 1930) is a, triangular five to six-storey housing block with a flat roof [ill. 4]. The complex volume seems composed of different shifted layers. The façades appear stretched and elongated. The window openings form a horizontal linear configuration. The windows are flush to the façade, but the integrated balconies create a strong relief. Brick walls are warm red and dark yellow, joints are light. The weathered brick façade with traces of repair has a slightly flickering quality. Window casements are white, and frames are dark brown.

Vestersøhus (Kay Fisker and C. F. Møller, 1935; 1939) is a firm, elongated seven-storey housing block with a flat roof [ill. 5]. The complex volume seems woven of walls, windows, and balconies. The façades appear progressive and elongated. The window openings form regular gaps between brick walls rather than holes in a wall. The

windows are flush to the façade, but the in- and outward going offsets create a heavy relief. Brick walls are warm brown-red, and the deep joints are dark. The weathered brick façade with deep joints has a crisp flickering quality. Window casements are dark brown, and frames are white.

Åboulevarden (Kay Fisker and C. F. Møller, 1932) is a solid, triangular six-storey housing block with a flat roof [ill. 6]. The clear volume seems like a block where the corners have been rounded. The façades appear even and calm. The window openings form a uniform grid, regularly interrupted by gutters and suspended balconies. Almost flush to the façade, the windows create a thin relief. Brick walls are warm brown-red, and the joints are light. The weathered brick façade has a slightly flickering quality. Window casements are white, and frames are dark brown.

Hornbækhus (Kay Fisker, 1922) is a solid, slightly skewed rectangular five-storey housing block with a pitched roof [ill. 7]. The clear volume seems like thin façade planes connected through broad, rusticated corners. The façades appear wide and calm. The window openings form a uniform grid, rhythmically interrupted by doors and gutters. Almost flush to the façade, the windows create a thin relief. Brick walls are warm brown-red, and the joints are light. The weathered brick façade with traces of repair has a calm flickering quality. Window casements are dark brown, and frames are white. All windows are lined with light render.

Fogedgaarden (Kay Fisker and C. F. Møller, 1943) is an ensemble of solid four- to five-storey housing blocks with steep pitched roofs [ill. 8]. The clear volumes seem placed shoulder to shoulder, three in a straight line, the fourth in a shifted line. The façades appear complex and varied. Small window openings form a shifted grid; larger window openings form a uniform grid. Small windows are flush to the façade, whereas larger windows create a vigorous relief. Brick walls are red-yellow striped, with a herringbone pattern around entrances; deep joints are dark. The weathered brick façades have a playful flickering quality. Window casements and frames are white.

Mødrehjælpen (Kay Fisker, 1953–1954) is a firm, elongated seven-storey housing project with low pitched roofs [ill. 9]. The clear two-by-three volumes seem like shifted thin façade planes. The façades

appear wide and tall. The large, almost square window openings form a uniform grid. Almost flush to the façade, the windows create a thin relief. Brick walls are dark yellow, and the deep joints are light. The weathered brick façade has a calm flickering quality. Slim window casements are white, and frames are dark brown.

Dronningegården (Kay Fisker, C. F. Møller and S. E. Kristensen, 1943–1958) is a porous, rectangular eight- to nine-storey housing block with pitched roofs [ill. 10]. The complex inward-oriented structure seems composed of multiple slightly shifted volumes. The façades appear complex and varied. Some window openings form a shifted grid, others form a uniform grid, regularly repeated. Smaller windows are flush to the façade, whereas terrace doors create a deep relief. Brick walls are warm brown-red, some with a yellow cross pattern, and the deep joints are dark. The weathered brick façade has a lively flickering quality. Window casements are dark brown, and frames are white. Balconies are lined with yellow bricks.

THE NINE-FIGURE GRID

In three of the nine works described above, the composition of windows seems most important to the overall composition. In Amagerbo [ill. 2] and Hornbækhus [ill. 7] this consists of a uniform grid, rhythmically interrupted by doors and gutters and in Gullfosshus [ill. 3] of a rhythmically repeated, but shifted grid, interrupted by rounded gates. In another three works, the form of the volume seems most significant; in Vodroffsvej [ill. 4] in the form of stacked and shifted layers, in Vestersøhus [ill. 5] in the form of a façade with a woven character and in Åboulevarden [ill. 6] in the form of a rounded, massive block. In yet another three, the configuration of building volumes plays a predominant role; in Fogedgaarden [ill. 8] in the form of volumes placed shoulder to shoulder, in Mødrehjælpen [ill. 9] in the form of two-by-three shifted volumes and in Dronningegården [ill. 10] in the form of differentiated and slightly shifted volumes.

Accordingly, Amagerbo, Hornbækhus, and Gullfosshus are placed in a category that may be called *mesh*; Vodroffsvej, Vestersøhus, and Åboulevarden are placed in a category called *figure*; and Fogedgaarden, Mødrehjælpen, and Dronningegården are placed in a category called *conglomerate*. Coincidentally, these categories – as

seen in a historic perspective, which is not the focus of this investigation – correspond to the time of construction. The early works built in the 1920s fall into the first, the later works built in the 1930s fall into the second, and the latest works built in the 1940s and 1950s fall into the third category. In addition to the horizontally placed overall motifs of mesh, figure, and conglomerate, the works are placed vertically in the nine-figure grid [ill. 1] according to the strength of the motive – going from the most subtle on the left to the more elaborated on the right.

A MATERIAL VOCABULARY

In all projects [ill. 2–10], the slightly varying tones of colour and the rich texture of the bricks themselves in combination with light or dark joints, all weathered over time and sometimes repaired, create a subtle vibrant effect. In four projects [ill. 3, 4, 8, and 10] lines or patterns of red and yellow bricks make the exterior even more lively. The colour of the window casements, frames, and bars – all white or in different combinations of brown and white – further animates the overall façade, just as the size of the individual window elements gives a delicate effect.

Window proportions themselves vary from approximately square to rectangular, either vertically or horizontally oriented, in one project close to the format of a ribbon window [ill. 4]. In the façade, the composition of windows creates a rhythmic constellation, either as a strict uniform grid [ill. 2, 5, 6, 7, and 9] or as regular repetitions of local groups of window and door elements, shifted to make an angular pattern [ill. 3, 4, 8 and 10]. Larger than the windows, the brick-wall area emphasises the solidity of the building volume. The depth of the joints as well as the positioning of the windows in the wall openings create a sometimes thin, at other times deep relief and results in light or dark shadow effects. Façades with a thin relief may seem like thin planes joined at the corners [ill. 2, 7, and 9] or wrapped around the volume [ill. 6], whereas façades with a deeper relief make the volumes seem a solid, perforated by window holes [ill. 3 and 8] or modelled by integrated balconies [ill. 4]. In two projects [ill. 5 and 10], the deep relief makes the façade seem neither like a plane, nor like a solid, but rather like a vertical weaving [ill. 5] or grate [ill. 10].

In some projects [ill. 2, 7, and 10], corner pillars are wider than the pillars between windows, and in others [ill. 3 and 8], corners are articulated by placing windows close together. In one project [ill. 6], corners are rounded, in others they seem woven of large horizontal layers [ill. 4] or threads [ill. 5]. In one project [ill. 9], the even width of corner and window pillars accentuates the façade as a thin plane. In all buildings [ill. 2–10], narrow eaves in combination with either flat, low, or steep pitched roofs accentuate the building as a solid volume.

All buildings [ill. 2–10] relate closely to the surrounding context regarding building height, street course, and façade order. Most works [ill. 2–7] do so by following the perimeter block structure of the dense city. One building [ill. 8] follows the street course but opens between the individual volumes. Another building follows the building block structure but inverted to create a large open square [ill. 10]. A single building [ill. 9] is withdrawn from the street, but with brick walls at the perimeter. Characteristically, all projects [ill. 2-10] stand out in a specific *mood* that may best be described as quiet, dignified presence.

As pointed out by Rasmussen: “External features become a means of communicating feelings and moods from one person to another.” (18) In this perspective, the material properties, façade composition, and volumetric qualities as described above may be understood as a material vocabulary that is not merely functional, typological, or historical but rather physical, aiming at communicating a felt architectural content.

In a phenomenological-philosophical perspective as described by Schmitz, language constitutes a holistic and meaningful entity composed of individual sentences that are meaningful programmes. (19) Intentionally articulating a content communicated from one person to another using a precise vocabulary, “the poet [...] weaves a net so thin that the situational network invoked by [them], especially in extended and complex lyrics, transpires in its entirety.” (20) In this perspective, the investigated works of Fisker may be understood as a highly nuanced and rich articulation of physical material formed into building elements. Like words, the elements have been combined grammatically according to their properties to articulate a syntactic whole allowing a *meaningful situation* with a holistic character to come to presentation. In the specific cases described above, this

communication is not loud and noisy but rather quiet and calm. Characterised by being compact, slightly sluggish but also robust, the works investigated may be described by what Schmitz calls the *bathmothyme,* which is one of three human dispositions of embodied dynamism that determines the space of the felt body. (21)

Across the investigated works [ill. 2–10], the architectural language includes a precise vocabulary of only few materials, strong textural effects, a limited colour range, simple details, subtle façade relief, repetition of elements, balanced proportions and harmonious composition. At once modestly withdrawn and yet strongly present, the nine works stand out as meaningful situations with a solemn but graceful holistic character that may best be described as *quiet attunement*, defined through a material vocabulary of vibrant materiality, subtle movement and compact whole that give a feeling of coherence and meaning.

A QUIET LANGUAGE

Focusing on the experienced effects of building exteriors only, this article does not consider the relation of inside to outside, functional programme, historical evolution, or other highly relevant aspects of Fisker's work. However, as proposed by Fisker himself in a 1927 lecture delivered in Helsinki, "the highest virtues of architecture are to be found in *proportions*, demanding meticulous consideration of every aspect." (22) This includes not only the two-dimensional relation of the individual parts in for instance a window, as the term is normally understood. As pointed out by Martin Søberg: "Proportionality should be understood in a broad sense, as relationality." (23) This concept of proportion resonates well with the concept of *eurythmy* as proposed by Vitruvius in his classic *Ten Books on Architecture*. (24) According to Vitruvius, the fundamental principles in architecture include order (ordinatio), arrangement (dispositio), eurythmy (eurythmia), symmetry (symmetria), propriety (decor), and economy (distributio). (25) In the definition proposed by Vitruvius, "Eurythmy is beauty and fitness in the adjustments of the members. This is found when the members of a work are of a height suited to their breadth, of a breadth suited to their length, and, in a word, when they all correspond symmetrically." (26) In

other words, the individual elements of a beautiful building must be proportionate to each other.

In his lecture, Fisker continues his argument by stating that: “The material is no longer judged for its fineness or historical justification but for its relation to its surroundings, colour and surface treatment, which in itself is also a proportionality consideration.” (27) As such, it is neither costly materials nor stylistic compliance that determines architectural quality. Rather, like the material language as described above, it is a question of bringing the individual building elements at all scales, including material properties, façade composition, and volumetric configuration – into correspondence to create a balanced whole.

According to Søberg, it is the typological and compositional ideas in the early large-scale housing projects that were “conceived as rational and logical – and consequently as appropriate [...] when giving form to a contemporary metropolis.” (28) However, as seen in the phenomenological-hermeneutic perspective as described above, it is neither the historic or stylistic nor the typological ideas that are decisive, but rather the elaborate material vocabulary that creates the internal and external proportionate whole.

A FRAMEWORK FOR THE GOOD LIFE

In his much later article *Persondyrkelse eller anonymitet* (Worship or Anonymity*)*, Fisker re-emphasises the importance of our surroundings being characterised by wholeness. (29) Much in line with Bernard Rudofsky’s contemporary argument in favour of an anonymous “non-pedigreed” and vernacular “architecture without architects,” Fisker argues that our built environment should be characterised by an anonymous and timeless architecture, not fashionable individual objects. (30) Rather than focusing on building autonomy and individual authorship, Fisker points out that: “We must remember that those architects who have the ability to plan our cities and our landscape and create a human environment with good housing as a setting in which to live the good life, are worth more to society than those who create a sensational, solitary work of art.” (31) To Fisker, attention should

be focused on regional conditions and manifested in anonymous and timeless buildings.

Echoing the critique of urban planning policy of the 1950s as advanced by Jane Jacobs, Fisker argues that architecture should provide a framework for a natural way of life and not be a goal in itself. According to Jacobs, planning principles should be about common, ordinary things such as safe streets and marvellous parks. Cities, like intricately interconnected organisms constitute "problems in organized complexity" that are "interrelated into an organic whole." (32) As pointed out by Jacobs: "The task is to promote the city life of city people, housed, let us hope, in concentrations both dense enough and diverse enough to offer them a decent chance at developing city life." (33) Accordingly, it is a question of relationality – in this case not just as a material principle between building parts, but as a comprehensive principle regarding the whole urban organism. It could be argued that the works of Fisker are too perfect, part of a "stagnant, self-referencing tradition" or even boring. (34) However, being simple, yet complex, the investigated works of Fisker appear both rather unnoticeable in the urban fabric and at the same time highly significant. With the eloquent and consistent use of the subtle architectural vocabulary as described above, the buildings themselves are not in focus. Instead, it is the experienced quiet presence created by the subtle architectural means, such as vibrant materiality, subtle movement, and compact whole, that provides quality as an urban framework.

A SAFE AND JUST SPACE FOR HUMANITY

Fisker's emphasis on the "good life" as the focus of architectural practice resonates well with the UN 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, which advocate for a world "where physical, mental and social well-being are assured." (35) However, as documented in the doughnut-shaped framework of social and planetary boundaries, not only the social foundation, but also the ecological ceiling of the planetary boundaries must be observed to operate within the safe and just space for humanity. In the latest update of the framework, it is pointed out that "the increase in ecological overshoot would have to stop immediately and accelerate nearly two times faster towards

planetary boundaries to safeguard Earth-system stability by 2050." [36] Since efficiency measures are not enough because of the rebound effect, it has been proposed that *sufficiency* be the primary principle. [37]

As described by Thomas Princen, modern economies represent an ever-increasing throughput of material and energy that ignores ecological limits and social consequences. [38] Threatening to undermine the economy itself, this extraction of resources, manufacture and use of products, and disposal of waste must be replaced with sufficiency principles prioritising meeting needs while minimising energy and material throughput. This is not to be confused with austerity or deprivation, rather seeking enough is to Princen both rational and ethical. [39] In an architectural perspective this includes optimising the use of buildings, re-purposing, organising the space and adjusting the size to needs, that is, transforming the buildings that are already there. [40] Interestingly, more than half a century ago Rudofsky pointed out that: "Not only is the need for confining the growth of a community well understood by the anonymous builders, it is matched by their understanding of the limits of architecture itself. They rarely subordinate the general welfare to the pursuit of profit and progress." [41] As a question of quality space rather than spatial quantity, the anonymous and timeless architectural framework around the good life created through a subtle, yet rich material vocabulary may in fact be decoupled from energy, material, and land-use demand.

In this perspective, returning to the safe operating space above the social foundation and below the ecological ceiling of the planetary boundaries requires that architectural practice in the Global North shifts its focus from new construction to the careful cultivation of the buildings that we already have. [42] Since dwelling concerns more than satisfying physical needs, the role of the architect today is not to increase the number of square meters but rather to create the appropriate emotional climate by means of the existing material at disposal. [43] A contemporary example, the Hedeskov Centre for Regenerative Practice project seeks to meet programmatic needs by transforming a former school building using bioregional and recycled materials with a low degree of processing. [44] With the use of an elaborate material vocabulary and subtle architectural means, architectural practice Djernes & Bell have brought the existing

building and new regenerative materials to be proportionate to each other. In this case, architectural quality is a question of using the available material in a rich and nuanced manner to articulate meaningful situations with a holistic character that invites the spectator to attune according to their mood.

QUIET ATTUNEMENT

In conclusion, the nine buildings designed by Fisker investigated here – as seen in a phenomenological-hermeneutic perspective – appear quiet, but not silent. Meaningful situations with a holistic character are created through a subtle, yet rich material vocabulary of vibrant materiality, subtle movement, and compact whole that give a feeling of coherence and meaning. Rather than understanding architecture as a typological question or a stylistic exercise, I propose that the investigated buildings are characterised by quiet attunement. As such, Fisker's work presents a viable alternative to object fetishism and spectacular concepts – rather than being "subject to fashion trends" or "inspired by great individual achievements." (45)

Accordingly, it may be argued that rather than focusing on building autonomy and individual authorship, the aim of the architect must be to create an anonymous and timeless framework around the good life. Since the housing problem in the Global North cannot be solved by building more in a biophysically limited world, sufficiency measures focusing on spatial quality should come first. In this perspective, the experienced architectural quality in the investigated work of Fisker can inspire future transformation practices that create a meaningful whole through an elaborate material vocabulary of subtle architectural means at all scales using the existing material at disposal. Constituting a feeling of coherence and meaning, the experiential qualities of Kay Fisker's work can thus serve as a model for sustainable building cultures of the future aiming at improving physical, mental, and social well-being in careful consideration of the planetary boundaries.

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NOTER

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17. Rasmussen, *Experiencing Architecture*, 32.

18. Rasmussen, *Experiencing Architecture*, 32.

19. Schmitz, *New Phenomenology*,74; Andersen, "New Phenomenology," 329.

20. Schmitz, *New Phenomenology*, 78.

21. Schmitz distinguishes between the compact *bathmothyme*, the rhythmic *zyklothyme*, and the balanced *skizothyme*.See, *Kroppen*, 86-87; Andersen, "New Phenomenology," 327.

22. Fisker as quoted in Martin Søberg, *Kay Fisker: Works and Ideas in Danish Modern Architecture* (Bloomsbury Visual Arts, 2021), 61, my emphasis.

23. Søberg, *Kay Fisker*, 62.

24. Vitruvius, *The Ten Books on Architecture,* trans. Morris Hicky Morgan (MA: Harvard University Press, 1914).

25. In fact, in some translations, the original term *eurythmia* is translated as *shapeliness* or *proportion*, see Marcus Vitruvius Pollio, *The Ten Books on Architecture*, trans. Morris Hicky Morgan, online edition, accessed 25 January 2026, bit.ly/VitruviusE1.

26. Vitruvius, *The Ten Books*, 14.

27. Fisker as quoted in Søberg, *Kay Fisker*, 61-62.

28. Martin Søberg, "Kay Fisker's Classical Principles for Modern Housing," in *Reflecting Histories and Directing Futures,* Proceedings Series 2019, vol. 1, ed. A. E. Toft, M. Rönn, and E. S. Wergeland (Nordic Academic Press of Architectural Research, 2019), 72 (55-74).

29. Fisker, "Persondyrkelse eller anonymitet," 522-526.

30. Bernard Rudofsky, *Architecture Without Architects: A Short Introduction to Non-Pedigreed Architecture* (New York: Doubleday, 1964), 6.

31. Fisker, "Persondyrkelse eller anonymitet," 526. Translation by the author.

32. Jane Jacobs, *The Death and Life of Great American Cities* (Vintage Books, 1992), 433.

33. Jacobs, *The Death and Life of Great American Cities*, 221.

34. Weiss and Vindum, *New Wave in Danish Architecture*.

35. United Nations, *Transforming Our World: The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development* (United Nations, 2015), 3.

36. Fanning and Raworth, "Doughnut of Social and Planetary Boundaries," 47.

37. See for instance Thomas Princen, *The Logic of Sufficiency* (MIT Press, 2005); Daniel W. O'Neill et al., "A Good Life for All within Planetary Boundaries," *Nature Sustainability* 1, no. 2 (2018): 88-95; Yamina Saheb, "COP26: Sufficiency Should Be First," *Buildings and Cities* (2021); IPCC, *Climate Change 2022: Mitigation of Climate Change.* (Cambridge University Press, 2022); Nicolai Bo Andersen, "Space Justice," *Magasin for Bygningskunst og Kultur* 7 (2024), https://bygningskunstogkultur.dk/nr-7-2024/space-justice.

38. Princen, *The Logic of Sufficiency*.

39. Princen, *The Logic of Sufficiency*.

40. IPCC, *Climate Change 2022: Mitigation of Climate Change.* (Cambridge University Press, 2022); Yamina Saheb, "COP26: Sufficiency Should Be First," *Buildings and Cities* (2021), https://www.buildingsandcities.org/insights/commentaries/cop26-sufficiency.html; Andersen, "Space Justice."

41. Rudofsky, *Architecture Without Architects*, 6.

42. See also Andersen, "Space Justice."

43. See Andersen, "New Phenomenology," 334.

44. Djernes and Bell, Hedeskov, and AAU BUILD, *Hedeskov Living Lab* (Aalborg: BUILD, Aalborg University, 2025).

45. Fisker, "Persondyrkelse eller anonymitet," 524. Translation by the author.



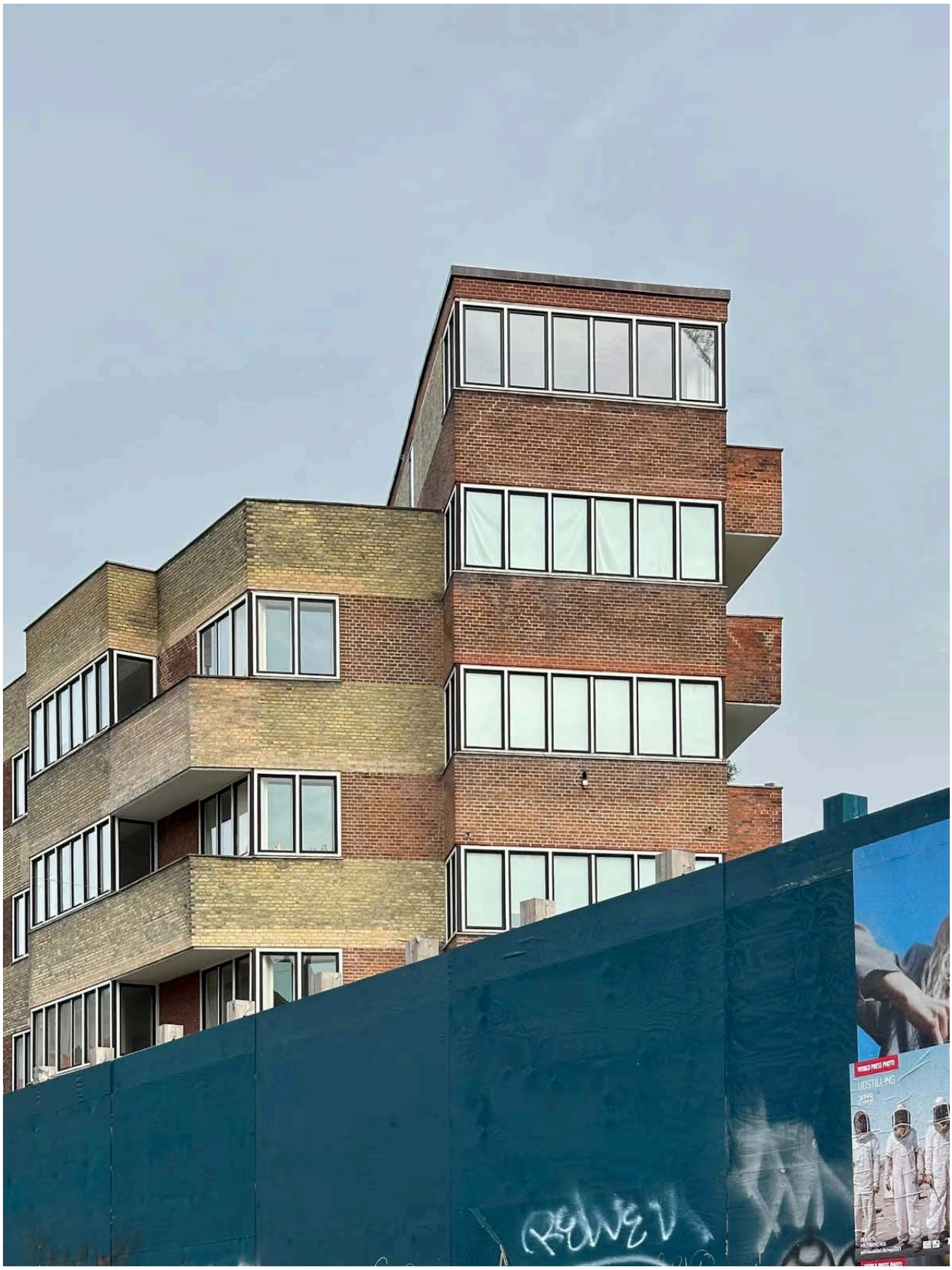
Ill. 1. The nine-figure grid. Photos: Nicolai Bo Andersen



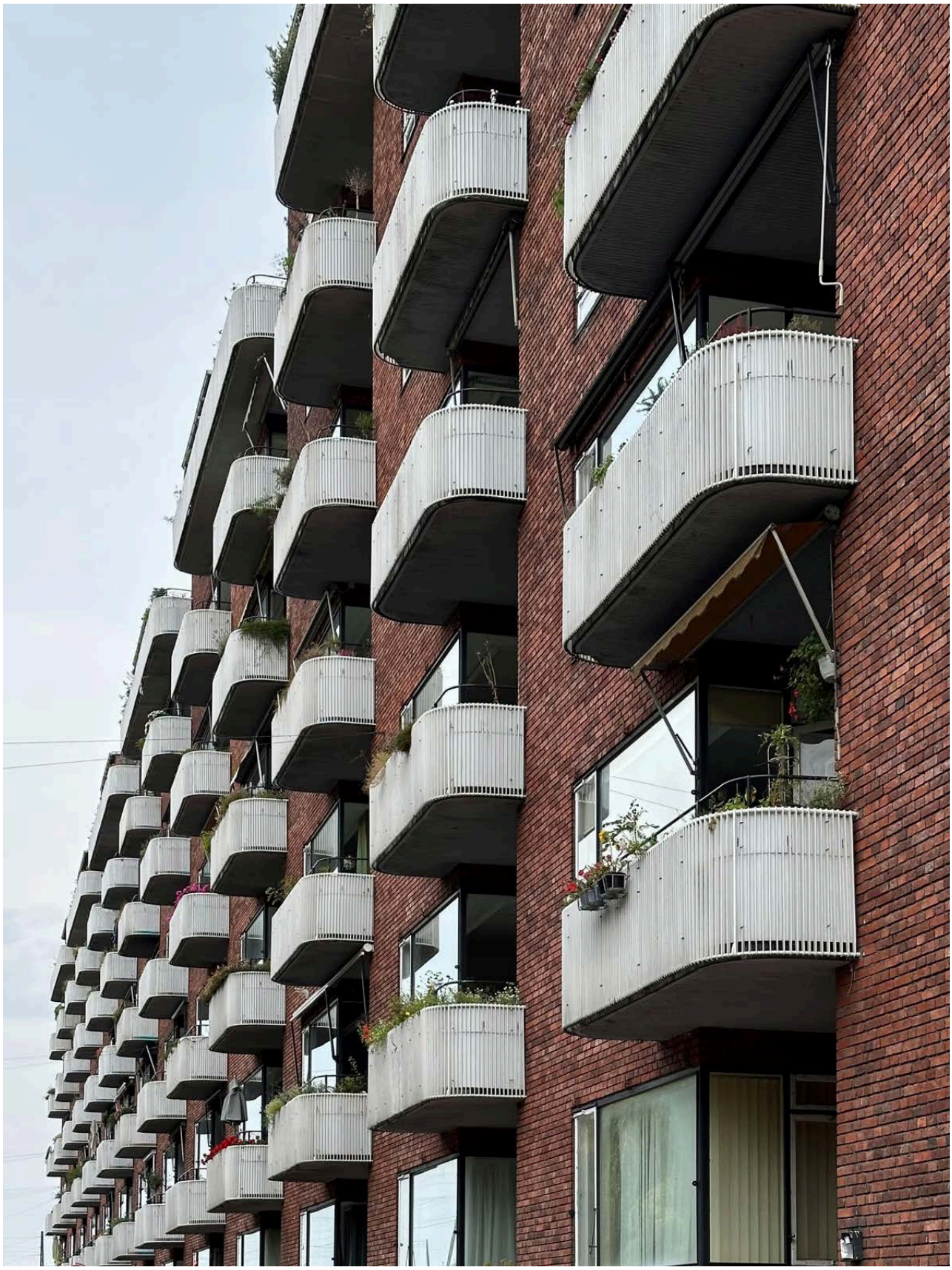
Ill. 2. Amagerbo. Kay Fisker and S. C. Larsen, 1926. Photo: Nicolai Bo Andersen



Ill. 3. Gullfosshus. Kay Fisker, 1928. Photo: Nicolai Bo Andersen



Ill. 4. Vodroffsvej. Kay Fisker and C. F. Møller, 1930. Photo: Nicolai Bo Andersen



Ill. 5. Vestersøhus. Kay Fisker and C. F. Møller, 1935; 1939. Photo: Nicolai Bo Andersen



Ill. 6. Åboulevarden. Kay Fisker and C. F. Møller, 1932. Photo: Nicolai Bo Andersen



Ill. 7. Hornbækhus. Kay Fisker, 1922. Photo: Nicolai Bo Andersen



Ill. 8. Fogedgården. Kay Fisker and C. F. Møller, 1943. Photo: Nicolai Bo Andersen



Ill. 9. Mødrehjælpen. Kay Fisker, 1953–1954. Photo: Nicolai Bo Andersen



Ill. 10. Dronningegården. Kay Fisker, C. F. Møller, and S.E. Kristensen, 1943-1958. Photo: Nicolai Bo Andersen